

Let us take the basic example of a spreadsheet, in say, home budgeting. Similar to MS Excel, you could enter the cell values as shown.

You'll need to set a date format first. This can be done by selecting the cells and clicking on the drop down button "Format". You will be provided alternate date formats from which you can easily select the one you are most comfortable working with. Start off by entering all the relevant data fields such as the recent expenses, the amount spent, the date, or amounts received from an external source. The screenshot gives a typical budgeting worksheet.

Google Spreadsheets comes complete with support for numerous formulae that make life much easier. To get a fair idea of how the value in this case was calculated, click on the Formula tab. If you are not familiar with the various formulae at your disposal, then you can learn by yourself with the help documentation provided by Google. Clicking on the Formula tab gives you a better understanding of the formula used.

The screenshot captures precisely this specific area. As you can see, the formula used was `C9=sum(C5:C7) - sum(C2:C4)`. The value displayed in cell C9 is 21350. Another interesting function is GoogleLookup—move over VLOOKUP and HLOOKUP in good old MS Excel!

For those of you aware of the VLOOKUP and HLOOKUP functions in MS Excel, this would be a blessing indeed. However, those of you who are not aware of the lookup function, it is a function



Spreadsheet's functionalities resemble MS Excel



Ready to budget your expenses on the go; as and when you remember transactions, just key them in!